Aruj Shukla

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Department of Economics
University of Southern California
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Firms, Labor Economics, Development Economics

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics
University of Southern California
2022–

MPP International Development Policy
Georgetown University
2018–2020

B.Eng. Materials Science & Engineering (*Minors in Business, Public Policy*)
Nanyang Technological University, Singapore
2010–2014

RESEARCH

Working Papers

2025 A. Shukla "Urban Insurance & Informal Networks" [email for draft]

2024 G. Barboni, A. Bhattacharya, E. Field, R. Pande, N. Rigol, S. Schaner, A. Shukla, and C. Troyer Moore "A Tough Call: Understanding the Impact of Mobile Technology on Women's Work, Gender Gaps, Social Norms, and Misinformation" *EGC Discussion Papers. 1109* [paper]

2024 A. Shukla "Supplying Vocational Training Institutes: Evidence from India" [email for draft]

In Progress

- *Learning-by-watching: YouTube and technology diffusion in LMICs*
- *Worker Turnover, Wage Contracts, and Firm Productivity in Uganda's Manufacturing Sector*
  with Virginia Minni & Anna Vitali

Technical Reports

- *Scaling Gender-Inclusive Social Audits: Preliminary Insights from Process Monitoring & a Randomized Controlled Trial*
  with Akash Bhatt, Madhulika Khanna, Simone Schaner, Charity Troyer Moore, and Natalie Theys [email for draft]
- *Teacher Value Added & Non-Cognitive Traits: Evidence from Pakistan* [email for draft]

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2020–22 Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow for Simone Schaner
Worked on projects in social safety nets, governance, financial inclusion, and gender economics
Center for Economic & Social Research (CESR), USC | Los Angeles, USA

2017–18 Data Associate
Swaniti Initiative | New Delhi, India

2014–17 Drilling Engineering Consultant
Stuart Wright Pte Ltd | Singapore

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2023–26 Teaching Assistant
Principles of Microeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Introduction to Econometrics
Economics Department, USC | Los Angeles, CA

2019–20 Teaching Assistant
Impact Evaluation for Development, Regression Methods & Analysis, Intermediate Microeconomics
McCourt School of Public Policy, Georgetown University | Washington DC

WORKSHOPS & CONFERENCES

2025 Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS) | UCLA, CA

2025 Research Transparency & Reproducibility Training (RT2) | UC Berkeley, CA

2024 ASREC Graduate Student Workshop | Chapman University, CA

AWARDS & GRANTS

2025 STEG Large Research Grant [£100,000]
(with Virginia Minni & Anna Vitali)

2025 Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics [$5,000]

2024 International Growth Centre (IGC) Full Research Grant [£60,000]
(with Virginia Minni & Anna Vitali)

2024 Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics [$5,000]
(with Marco Lo Faso)

2024, '25 Summer Research Award [$4,000]
University of Southern California

LANGUAGES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software Stata, R, LaTeX, Git, Python, SQL

Language English, Hindi

Updated January 2026